



Department of Toxic Substances Control



Winston H. Hickox
Agency Secretary
California Environmental
Protection Agency

Edwin F. Lowry, Director
5976 Corporate Avenue
Cypress, California 90630

Gray Davis
Governor

October 7, 2003

Mr. Bob Sendzik
Facilities Planning Support Manager
Capistrano Unified School District
32972 Calle Perfecto
San Juan Capistrano, California 92675-4792

PHASE I ENVIRONMENTAL SITE ASSESSMENT ADDENDUM DETERMINATION,
CAPISTRANO UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT, PROPOSED OSO GRANDE SCHOOL,
SIENNA PARKWAY AND O'NEILL DRIVE, LADERA RANCH, ORANGE COUNTY
(SITE CODE 404477-11)

Dear Mr. Sendzik:

The Department of Toxic Substances Control (DTSC) reviewed the Phase I Environmental Site Assessment Addendum (Addendum), dated October 2, 2003, received October 6, 2003 and a clarification letter, dated September 16, 2003, both prepared by NMG Geotechnical, Incorporated (NMG). The Addendum and clarification letter were forwarded in response to a previous determination that a Preliminary Environmental Assessment (PEA) was required for the site. Based on review of the original Phase I Environmental Assessment, dated February 2002, DTSC originally determined a PEA was required on September 8, 2003.

The approximately ten-acre site is currently vacant, graded land. Historically, the site was part of a former, large cattle ranch, used for dry farming and grazing. Due to mass grading operations, DTSC had concerns of potential methane impacts due to degradation of organic material that may exist within the fill material. The clarification letter confirms that during grading operations, site vegetation is removed from the surface prior to commencing cut and fill activities. Based on review of geotechnical borings, NMG confirmed that fill material on site is free from organic material and therefore would not generate methane.

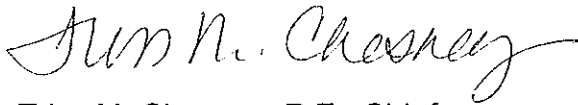
Based on the information provided in the Addendum and a site visit conducted by DTSC on September 30, 2003, neither a release of hazardous material nor the presence of naturally occurring hazardous material, which would pose a threat to human health or the environment under unrestricted land use, was indicated at the site.

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Therefore, DTSC concurs with the conclusion of the Addendum that further environmental investigation of the site is not required and hereby approves the Addendum. As with any real property, if previously unidentified contamination is discovered at the Site, additional assessment, investigation, and cleanup may be required.

If you have any questions, please contact Ms. Robbie Morris, Project Manager, at (619) 278-3761 or me at (714) 484-5447.

Sincerely,



Triss M. Chesney, P.E., Chief
Schools Unit – Cypress Office
School Property Evaluation and Cleanup Division

cc: Mr. Michael O'Neill
Environmental/Consultant Coordinator
School Facilities Planning Division
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bcc: Ms. Angie Alfaro-Glendale

Ms. Robbie Morris-Cypress

Cypress Schools Unit Reading File